HIRESNIX

ELEVATING TALENT. EMPOWERING FUTURES.

Hiresnix Labs: from Ubuntu installation to running the labs

A complete step-by-step guide for a new Windows laptop. Everything runs inside Ubuntu, so Docker is not needed.

> **Time needed:** about 15 to 20 minutes the first time, then about 10 seconds every day after that. **You need:** Windows 10 or 11 and an internet connection for the first run.

PART A Set up Ubuntu only once per laptop

1 Open PowerShell as administrator

- Open the Start menu and search for **PowerShell**.
- Right-click it, choose **Run as administrator**, then click **Yes**.

2 Install Ubuntu

- In PowerShell, type this command and press Enter:

```
wsl --install -d Ubuntu
```

- Let it download and install. If it asks you to **restart** the laptop, restart it.
- If it says `A distribution with the supplied name already exists`, Ubuntu is already installed: go to step 3.

3 Open Ubuntu

- Search for **Ubuntu** in the Start menu and click **Ubuntu (Linux distribution)**, the one with the orange icon.
- Do not open "Ubuntu (App in Microsoft Store)": that is only the store page.
- The first start takes a minute.

4 Create your username and password

- When it shows `Enter new UNIX username:`, type a name in small letters with no spaces (for example `amar`) and press Enter.
- When it shows `New password:`, type a password and press Enter, then type it again. **Nothing appears on screen while you type**; that is normal.
- **Remember this password.** You will need it in step 7.

Ubuntu is ready when you see a line like this:

```
amar@Laptop:~$
```

PART B Download the labs only once

5 Download the project into Ubuntu

- In the same Ubuntu window, run this command. To paste in Ubuntu, **right-click** (or press Ctrl+Shift+V).

```
git clone https://github.com/AmarBorse/hiresnix-labs.git
```

> This puts the project in your Ubuntu home folder (**`~/hiresnix-labs`**). It is faster than a folder on the Windows C: drive, and there is no path to look up. Already downloaded the ZIP in Windows instead? See "Using a ZIP downloaded in Windows" at the end.

PART C Start the labs first time

6 Go into the project and start it

```
cd hiresnix-labs
bash start.sh
```

7 Enter your Ubuntu password

- When **`Password:`** appears, type the password from step 4 and press Enter.
- It is needed once, to install a few tools.

8 Wait while it installs

- Tools, Node.js and the app's packages download. This takes 2 to 5 minutes.
- **Do not close the window.**

9 Open the labs in your browser

- When you see **`Hiresnix Labs is running at http://localhost:8080`**, open this address in Chrome or Edge:

```
http://localhost:8080
```

- Start with **Linux Fundamentals**. Under every step, **Commands in this step** explains each command in simple English.
- Keep the Ubuntu window open while you use the labs.

PART D Every day after that

To stop: press **Ctrl+C** in the Ubuntu window.

To start again: open Ubuntu and run this, then open **`http://localhost:8080`**. Nothing is installed again, so it starts in seconds.

```
cd ~/hiresnix-labs && bash start.sh
```

PART E Get the latest version when the labs are updated

```
cd ~/hiresnix-labs
git pull
bash start.sh
```

- Then press **Ctrl+F5** in the browser so it loads the new version.

Using a ZIP downloaded in Windows

If you downloaded the ZIP from GitHub and extracted it in Windows, go to that folder from Ubuntu. **`/mnt/c/`** is the Windows C: drive. First find your Windows user name:

```
ls /mnt/c/Users
```

Then go to the folder and check that it contains **start.sh**, **labs** and **src**:

```
cd /mnt/c/Users/<windows-name>/Downloads/hiresnix-labs
ls
```

> **"start.sh: No such file or directory"?** Extracting a ZIP often makes a folder inside a folder (**`hiresnix-labs/hiresnix-labs`** or **`hiresnix-labs-main`**). If **`ls`** shows only one folder, go into it with **`cd`** and run **`bash start.sh`** there.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
start.sh: No such file or directory	You are in the wrong folder. Run **`ls`**: if you see a folder instead of start.sh, go into it with **`cd hiresnix-labs`** and try again.
Release file ... is not valid yet	Ubuntu's clock is behind (common after the laptop sleeps). The script fixes it by itself; if not, run **`sudo hwclock -s`**, or **`wsl --shutdown`** in PowerShell, then try again.
Forgot the Ubuntu password	In PowerShell: **`wsl -d Ubuntu -u root passwd <username>`** and set a new one.
Port is already in use	Run **`LABS_PORT=9090 bash start.sh`** and open http://localhost:9090
git: command not found	Run **`sudo apt update && sudo apt install -y git`**, then step 5 again.
Error about virtualization (0x80370102) during step 2	Virtualization is switched off in the laptop BIOS. Turn on "Intel VT-x" or "AMD-V / SVM" in the BIOS settings, then run step 2 again.
"Access is denied" in step 2	PowerShell is not running as administrator. Repeat step 1.
Docker Desktop is installed	No problem: this method runs inside Ubuntu and does not use Docker.

Quick reference. First time: **`git clone https://github.com/AmarBorse/hiresnix-labs.git`**, then **`cd hiresnix-labs`**, then **`bash start.sh`**. Every day: **`cd ~/hiresnix-labs && bash start.sh`**. Browser: **`http://localhost:8080`**. Stop: **Ctrl+C**.

Stuck? Send a screenshot of the Ubuntu window and the step number to the Hiresnix team. Source code: https://github.com/AmarBorse/hiresnix-labs